fatal casualties, while almost all the others who were overpowered and taken prisoner were wounded.

Dubey had been left for dead, but the next day as the Chinese mopping up teams were looking for survivors, they realized the officer was alive. Along with Dashrath, who was saved from an executioner's bullet by the Chinese nurse, Dubey, perhaps by virtue of the fact that he was an officer, was also taken prisoner despite the severity of his wounds. Thus ended the saga of the westernmost position of 2 Rajput at Temporary Bridge.

TO THE LAST MAN

The Gujjars of Bravo Company were in a state of shock, having just seen their company commander charred to death. However, taking immediate charge of the situation, Subedar Har Lal shouted to the men to get behind the trees and rocks and face the rear slope. 'Make your fire count,' he said, 'and then use the rifle as a lathi to club any Chinese who gets in close.' Jemadar Gian Chand's No. 4 Platoon had also just about managed to turn around when an avalanche of khaki-clad Chinese troops began to pour down on the two platoons.

Subedar Mohan Lal, the senior company JCO, and the men in Company HQ just above the burning bunker of the company commander were killed in the first wave as they had no protection. Both No. 5 and No. 4 Platoon however, using the dense tree cover and firing systematically into the mass of troops bearing down on them, succeeded in temporarily halting the Chinese. But in the confined space the Chinese could only go downhill. After regrouping, they launched a second attack, then a third. In this unequal battle, the men fell one by one until no one was left. Some men, having run out of ammunition, still refused to surrender, only to be brought down by bursts of automatic fire.

As both Har Lal and Jemadar Gian Chand went down in a hail of bullets with their men, the Chinese turned their undivided attention towards Hoshiar Singh's position, which was lower down on the spur overlooking the log bridge. The men, having had a little more time to take stock of the situation as the upper layers of the company had taken the initial brunt of the attack, had watched the firefight develop into hand-to-hand combat as the Chinese repeatedly tried to close the gap. Hoshiar and his platoon were shooting at the flanking Chinese with deadly accuracy, the .303 rifles being extremely effective at that range. However, the bolt action meant a slower